



#### ◀ PANZERKAMPFWAGEN III MEDIUM TANK, AUSF M

**Date** 1939 **Origin** Germany

**Weight** 23.5 tonnes (25.9 tons)

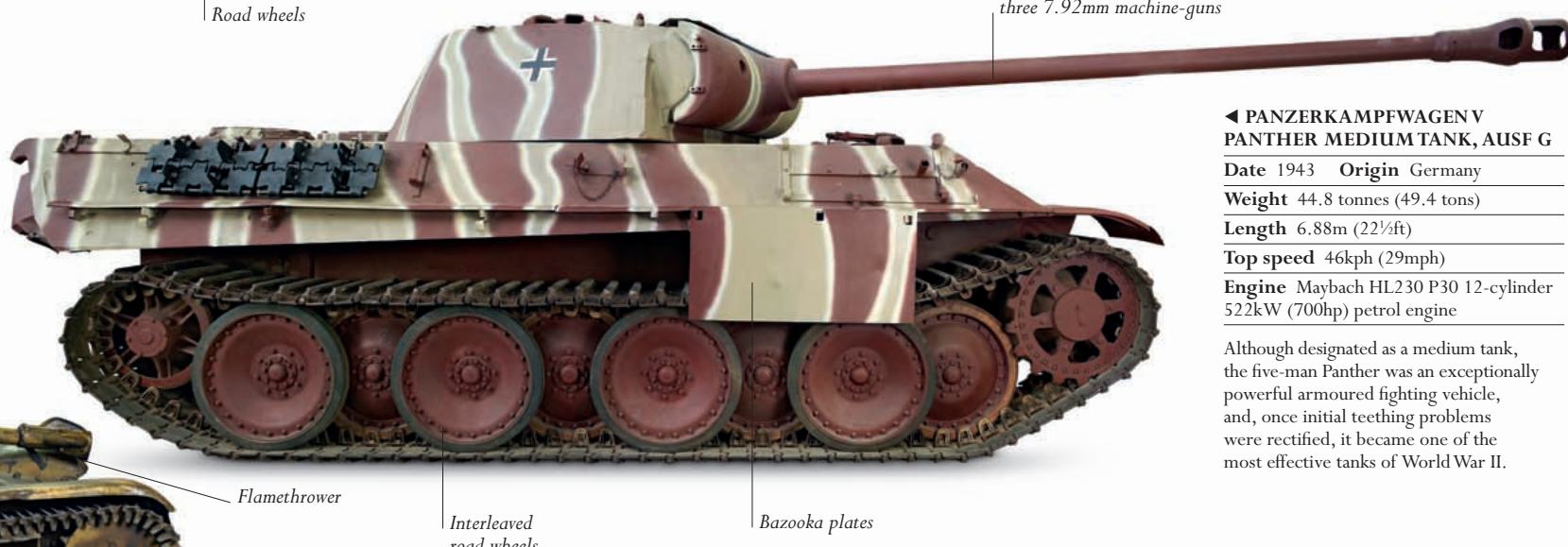
**Length** 6.41m (21ft)

**Top speed** 40kph (25mph)

**Engine** Maybach HL 120TRM 12-cylinder  
224kW (300hp) petrol engine

The Panzer III entered service in 1939 as the German army's main battle tank, but by the end of 1941 its inferiority to the Soviet T-34 had become evident and it was adapted to act as a chassis for other armoured vehicles. This mark was manned by five crew.

Armed with a 75mm KwK 42 main gun as well as two or three 7.92mm machine-guns



#### ◀ PANZERKAMPFWAGEN V PANTHER MEDIUM TANK, AUSF G

**Date** 1943 **Origin** Germany

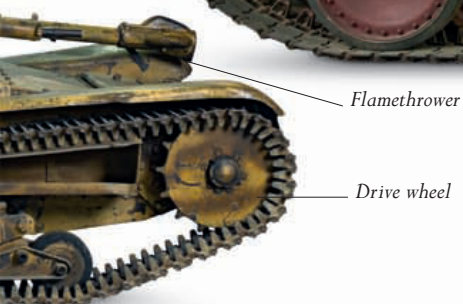
**Weight** 44.8 tonnes (49.4 tons)

**Length** 6.88m (22½ft)

**Top speed** 46kph (29mph)

**Engine** Maybach HL230 P30 12-cylinder  
522kW (700hp) petrol engine

Although designated as a medium tank, the five-man Panther was an exceptionally powerful armoured fighting vehicle, and, once initial teething problems were rectified, it became one of the most effective tanks of World War II.



#### ▲ PANZERKAMPFWAGEN VI TIGER I HEAVY TANK, AUSF E

**Date** 1942 **Origin** Germany

**Weight** 56 tonnes (61.7 tons)

**Length** 6.20m (20¾ft)

**Top speed** 38kph (24mph)

**Engine** Maybach HL230 P45 12-cylinder  
522kW (700hp) petrol engine

Adopting a design philosophy that emphasized protection and firepower, the Tiger was a fearsome weapon, but it lacked manoeuvrability. It was also costly to manufacture.

#### ◀ PANZERKAMPFWAGEN VI TIGER II HEAVY TANK, AUSF B

**Date** 1944 **Origin** Germany

**Weight** 69.8 tonnes (76.9 tons)

**Length** 7.26m (23¾ft)

**Top speed** 38kph (24mph)

**Engine** Maybach HL230 P30 12-cylinder  
522kW (700hp) petrol engine

The Tiger II (or King Tiger), which was operated by five crew members, was arguably the most powerful tank fielded by any side in World War II. However, its immense weight caused a series of reliability problems, which hampered its battlefield performance.